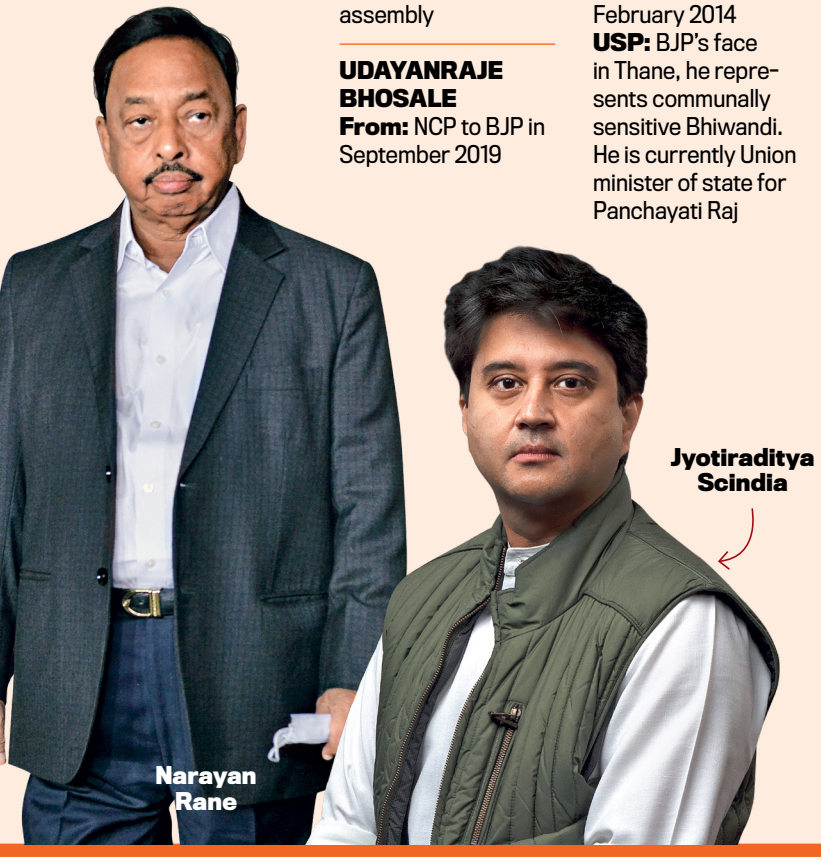
CENTRAL

★ **BHARATI PAWAR**
From: NCP to BJP in March 2019
USP: A senior leader of the NCP, she switched over to the BJP before 2019 polls. Has since been made a Union minister

RAHUL NARWEKAR
From: NCP to BJP in September 2019
USP: Comes from an influential political family. He unsuccessfully contested the 2014 Lok Sabha election on an NCP ticket from Maval. He was the party's face in the media. Currently speaker of the state assembly

UDAYANRAJE BHOSALE
From: NCP to BJP in September 2019
USP: A descendent of Chhatrapati Shivaji, Bhosale was a two-term NCP MP. Before that, he was a two-term MLA on the BJP's ticket. Currently, he is a Rajya Sabha MP

★ **KAPIL MORESHWAR PATIL**
From: NCP to BJP in February 2014
USP: BJP's face in Thane, he represents communally sensitive Bhiwandi. He is currently Union minister of state for Panchayati Raj



MADHYA PRADESH

★ **JYOTIRADITYA SCINDIA**
From: Congress to BJP in 2020
USP: A scion of the Scindias of Gwalior, he was one of Rahul Gandhi's most trusted lieutenants. He broke away with 22 MLAs, resulting in the fall of the Kamal Nath government in 2020. He is currently Union minister for civil aviation and steel

KP YADAV
From: Congress to BJP in April 2018
USP: Joined the BJP in 2018 to contest the Assembly election from Mungaoli. Lost the election, but won the Lok Sabha poll in 2019 in Guna, defeating Scindia

SANJEEV KUSHWAHA
From: BSP to BJP in June 2022
USP: A lone ranger of the BSP. Has presence in the Bhind region. His father, Dr Ramlakhan Kushwaha, was a four-term BJP MP for Bhind

RAJESH SHUKLA
From: SP to BJP in June 2022
USP: A former Congressman, Shukla's family has sizeable influence in the state's Bundelkhand area. He had switched over to the SP after the Congress denied him a ticket; is now a member of the BJP

GOVIND SINGH RAJPUT
From: Congress to BJP
USP: One of the 22 Congress MLAs who switched over to the BJP in March 2020 and led to the fall of the Kamal Nath government. He is now state transport minister.

★ Union Ministers

THERE'S ONE OUTLIER HERE, IN THE SHAPE OF THE TRINAMOOL. THE DOUGHTY **MAMATA HAS DONE A BJP ON THE BJP,** HAVING ALREADY POACHED SOME SEVEN WINNING FACES FROM THE SAFFRON PARTY

plane, at the upper echelons of the party—this is no museum where sundry scalps and trophies are hung up on the wall. The incoming leader is given due respect, prominence and formal investitures into positions of power precisely because he or she is not a solo immigrant. A leader who switches sides is also directly related to a horizontal reality; each new entrant heralds a geographical expansion into newer territories. He or she also often brings a band of loyal MLAs and a dedicated cadre base, with roots in specific zones. It's a whole piece of the Indian political soil that goes over to the BJP.